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W H I T E P A P E R

**Microsoft Copilot for
Public Sector**

An Executive Decision Guide for Agency and Institutional Leaders

Federal | State and Local | Higher Education
ATO | FedRAMP | FISMA | Privacy Act | Records Management | Section 508

2026 Edition
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Executive Summary

Microsoft Copilot is one of the most consequential technology decisions a public sector leader will face in the next two years. The mission case is real: government knowledge workers who adopt Copilot effectively recapture one to two hours per day, meeting overhead drops, and institutional knowledge becomes accessible in seconds instead of requiring a senior colleague's time. Agencies that compress administrative cycle times redirect that capacity toward mission delivery. That is the case for investing.

The risk in public sector is different in kind from commercial risk. Government AI deployments carry authorization obligations, statutory privacy requirements, records management law, procurement constraints, and workforce relations dynamics that do not exist in the private sector. A public sector leader who treats a Copilot deployment as a standard software rollout will encounter compliance gaps, authorization delays, and workforce objections that were entirely preventable with proper preparation.

This paper is written for agency CIOs, state technology executives, university chief information officers, and the senior leaders who report to them. It does not recite product specifications. It covers the compliance landscape, the authorization sequencing, the governance requirements, and the human realities specific to government and institutional environments. Every section drives toward a decision a public sector executive actually has to make.

What Public Sector CXOs Need to Know Before They Approve

The ATO process for federal agencies adds 60 to 120 days to a deployment timeline that commercial organizations do not experience. Plan for this before committing to a go-live date.

GCC and GCC High environments carry feature limitations relative to commercial Copilot. Validate feature availability in the specific government cloud environment before scoping the deployment.

Privacy Act obligations, FOIA implications, and federal records law each create governance requirements that are unique to government. None of them can be addressed after the fact.

Government employees respond to mission-outcome framing, not productivity marketing. The communication and training strategy must reflect this or adoption will stall.

Section 508 accessibility compliance is a legal requirement for federal agencies. All training materials and any Copilot-adjacent tools must meet this standard before delivery.

Procurement must run through an approved contract vehicle. Confirm the vehicle before engaging an implementation partner or signing a statement of work.

Section 1: What Copilot Does in a Government Context

1.1 The Functional Reality

Microsoft Copilot connects to organizational data through Microsoft Graph, indexing email, calendar, files, meetings, and Teams conversations within the tenant. It operates within the permission structure that already exists in the environment. It surfaces no content a user cannot already access through normal Microsoft 365 use. That sentence carries more operational significance in a government environment than it does anywhere else, because government systems often contain content with access controls that have not been audited in years.

In practice, Copilot performs four functions that deliver direct public sector value: content generation from natural language prompts (policy documents, briefings, correspondence, program reports); data analysis across spreadsheets without manual formula work; real-time meeting intelligence including action item extraction from program reviews and interagency calls; and knowledge retrieval from files, email, and Teams conversations the user has permission to access. The fourth function is where government organizations see the fastest mission impact. Institutional knowledge that previously lived in the heads of senior career staff becomes queryable by anyone on the team.

1.2 The Mission Case

Mission Value Driver	Mechanism	Documented Range
Staff time recapture	Reduced drafting, summarization, and information retrieval time	1 to 2 hours per staff member per day at sustained adoption
Institutional knowledge access	New staff and rotators query organizational precedent without waiting for senior colleagues	30 to 50% faster productivity ramp for new assignees
Meeting cycle efficiency	AI summaries replace manual note-taking across program reviews and interagency calls	30 to 45 minutes per meeting cycle
Briefing preparation	Faster research and draft generation for congressional testimony and oversight response	20 to 35% reduction in preparation cycle time
Administrative burden reduction	Routine correspondence and policy updates completed faster	15 to 25% reduction in administrative task cycle time

1.3 The Government-Specific Preparation Problem

Copilot amplifies the state of the organization's data permissions, for better or worse. In government environments where SharePoint has grown for years with minimal governance, Copilot will surface documents across organizational boundaries in ways that create both data exposure risk and potential CUI commingling if the environment is not properly structured before launch. The compliance frameworks that govern government data handling make this more consequential than in a commercial environment.

Three realities specific to government require preparation before a responsible deployment: government cloud environments carry feature limitations that commercial demonstrations do not show; authorization obligations create a compliance gate that cannot be bypassed or compressed; and government employees have a well-developed awareness of oversight scrutiny that shapes how they will receive and use any new technology tool.

Section 2: The Compliance Landscape

Every public sector Copilot deployment operates within a compliance framework that has no commercial equivalent. CXOs who understand this landscape before they approve the investment make better decisions, engage the right stakeholders earlier, and avoid the authorization failures that consume program budget and credibility.

2.1 Federal Compliance Requirements

Requirement	What It Means for Copilot
FedRAMP Authorization	Copilot must operate in a FedRAMP-authorized environment. GCC carries Moderate; GCC High carries High. Confirm Microsoft's current authorization for the specific environment before deployment begins. Authorizations update. Check current status, not historical documentation.
FISMA and ATO	Adding Copilot to an existing M365 system may constitute a significant change requiring an updated Authority to Operate. Federal agencies cannot deploy Copilot to production without the Authorizing Official's documented approval. This is not procedural paperwork. It is a legal prerequisite.
Privacy Act of 1974	AI-assisted processing of Privacy Act-covered records requires a Privacy Impact Assessment update. The agency Privacy Officer must be engaged before Copilot processes any Privacy Act-protected records. This obligation applies regardless of how the deployment is scoped.
Federal Records Act and NARA	Copilot-generated content that constitutes a federal record must be captured under the agency's approved records schedule. Meeting summaries, AI-drafted correspondence used in official decisions, and program documentation are the most common record-qualifying outputs.
Section 508	All technology deployed by federal agencies must meet Section 508 accessibility standards. Copilot itself carries Microsoft's VPAT, but any training materials, custom interfaces, or Copilot-adjacent tools must be independently reviewed and confirmed compliant before mandatory deployment to staff.
EO 14110 and NIST AI RMF	Federal agencies must align AI deployments with the NIST AI Risk Management Framework. The governance framework established for Copilot should explicitly reference AI RMF alignment and document the risk management decisions made during planning.

2.2 State, Local, and Higher Education Considerations

State and local governments do not carry federal FISMA obligations, but they operate within a compliance landscape that varies significantly by jurisdiction and is becoming more demanding each year.

- **State AI policy:** more than 30 states have enacted or proposed AI governance legislation. Confirm whether the state has specific requirements for AI tools used in government service delivery before scoping the deployment.
- **State public records laws:** government electronic records, including AI-generated content used in official decisions, are subject to public records laws in most states. Confirm the records management implication of each planned use case.
- **Data residency requirements:** some states require that government data remain within specific geographic boundaries. Validate that the Microsoft cloud environment meets any applicable residency requirement before selecting it.
- **FERPA (higher education):** any Copilot workflow touching student educational records requires a FERPA analysis before deployment. This applies to advising, enrollment, financial aid, and student services applications.

- **Research data obligations:** universities receiving federal research funding have data handling requirements under NSF, NIH, and agency-specific data management plans. Copilot use in research workflows requires review against these obligations.

Section 3: Cloud Environment and Procurement

3.1 Choosing the Right Government Cloud

The cloud environment determination is the most consequential technical decision in a federal Copilot deployment. It defines what Copilot can do, what it cannot do, what compliance authorizations apply, and how long feature gaps will persist relative to the commercial product. Make this decision in the planning phase with the CIO, ISSO, and legal counsel, and document it in writing before any procurement action begins.

Environment	Required When	FedRAMP Level	Copilot Feature Notes
M365 GCC	Federal civilian non-sensitive data; most state and local government	Moderate	Most Copilot features available; some lag commercial by 30 to 90 days
M365 GCC High	CUI handling; DFARS-obligated contractors; ITAR-controlled data	High	Reduced feature set; 90 to 180 day lag behind commercial; Copilot Studio limited
M365 DoD	DoD components; defense agencies; classification-adjacent work	IL2/IL4/IL5	Significantly restricted; confirm specific features with Microsoft Government before scoping
M365 Commercial	State and local not handling federal data; private entities supporting government	Not applicable	Full feature set; fastest access to new capabilities; requires legal review for eligibility

One caution applies regardless of which environment is selected: do not scope a deployment based on a commercial product demonstration. GCC High in particular carries feature limitations that are material to the use cases agencies most commonly prioritize. Verify current feature availability for the specific environment with the Microsoft Government team before finalizing scope, and document that verification.

3.2 Procurement Vehicles

Government Copilot services must be procured through approved contract vehicles. Confirming the vehicle before engaging an implementation partner is not administrative caution. It is a legal obligation that, if missed, can delay the entire program while a compliant vehicle is established.

- **GSA Multiple Award Schedule (MAS IT):** the most common federal civilian vehicle for IT advisory and training services. Task Orders are agency-initiated. Confirm that the implementation partner holds an active MAS contract and that the SINs align with Copilot advisory and training services.
- **NASA SEWP V:** preferred at DoD and technology-intensive civilian agencies. Faster procurement cycle for technology-adjacent services.
- **CIO-SP3 and CIO-SP4 (NIH GWAC):** preferred at health-related agencies; expanding use across civilian government.

- **State cooperative purchasing (NASPO ValuePoint):** reduces procurement cycle time for state and local organizations authorized to use cooperative agreements. Confirm state eligibility before proposing this path.

Confirm the specific vehicle, the period of performance, and the ceiling before execution begins. Government contracts have fixed periods of performance. Work needed after the PoP ends requires a modification. Scope drift that causes the engagement to exceed the PoP without a documented modification is a contract compliance failure.

Section 4: Authorization and Pre-Deployment Readiness

The authorization workstream is the aspect of public sector Copilot deployment that most consistently surprises agency leaders who have not deployed AI tools in a federal environment before. It is not procedural paperwork. It is a substantive process requiring time, documentation, and coordination among the ISSO, the Privacy Officer, the Authorizing Official, and the legal team. CXOs who plan deployment timelines without accounting for authorization will either delay their launch or deploy without proper authorization. Neither outcome is acceptable.

4.1 The ATO: Three Scenarios and Their Timelines

Scenario	What Triggers It	Timeline
Minor change to existing ATO	ISSO determines Copilot does not materially change security categorization or data flows of the existing M365 system	4 to 8 weeks for change assessment documentation and AO acknowledgment
Significant change to existing ATO	Copilot assessed as a significant change due to AI-assisted data processing, new data flows, or expanded user data access	8 to 16 weeks for updated System Security Plan, controls assessment, and AO re-approval
New ATO required	Agency has no existing M365 ATO, or the deployment moves to a new cloud environment (for example, migrating from Commercial to GCC High)	16 to 24 weeks for full ATO package; an Interim Authority to Test may be available after 8 to 12 weeks for controlled pilot use

The Rule That Cannot Be Waived

Federal agencies that begin Copilot technical configuration before ATO status is confirmed create a system change without authorization documentation.

This is a FISMA compliance gap, not a documentation delay.

The ISSO must be the first stakeholder engaged, before any vendor discussion of technical configuration.

If the ISSO is not resourced to support the authorization workstream, resolve that resource gap before committing to any deployment timeline.

4.2 Privacy Impact Assessment

Adding Copilot to an agency's M365 environment almost always constitutes a significant modification to an existing IT system for Privacy Act PIA purposes. The agency's Senior Agency Official for Privacy must make this determination and, if a PIA update is required, coordinate its completion before Copilot processes any Privacy Act-covered records. A PIA update documents what categories of PII may flow through Copilot-assisted workflows, how Copilot processes that information, what data retention applies to Copilot interaction logs, and how individual rights under the Privacy Act are preserved. This is not a technology team deliverable. It requires legal and privacy officer involvement from the start.

4.3 Records Management

The Federal Records Act requires that federal records be captured, maintained, and dispositioned under approved records schedules. Copilot creates three categories of potential federal records that the agency records officer must assess before deployment: meeting summaries generated from Teams meetings that discuss program decisions or leadership direction; AI-drafted correspondence sent on behalf of the agency; and AI-generated analysis or briefing documents that inform official decisions, even when the final document is written by a human. The records officer must determine whether each output category falls under the agency's NARA-approved schedule, establish a capture mechanism that routes record-qualifying outputs into a records-managed system, and confirm that all Copilot users understand their records management obligations before they receive a license.

4.4 Data Governance Before Launch

Microsoft Graph applies no additional filtering beyond what already exists in the environment. If a user can access a file, Copilot can retrieve it. In government environments, the data governance risks extend beyond the oversharing patterns that affect commercial organizations. Agencies that have stored CUI in broadly permissioned SharePoint sites or in inadequately labeled document libraries will find that Copilot surfaces that content to users who technically have access but who should not be retrieving CUI through an AI-assisted query.

Pre-deployment data governance work in government includes a SharePoint permissions audit with specific attention to CUI, privacy-sensitive records, and pre-decisional content; Microsoft Purview sensitivity label deployment with a taxonomy that includes CUI category labels; DLP policy configuration that detects CUI patterns in addition to standard PII; and external sharing policy review for sites that may have been opened to contractor access and never tightened. For a medium-sized agency in partial readiness, this work takes four to eight weeks. It is not compressible.

Section 5: Governance Framework

AI governance in government is a leadership accountability with statutory dimensions that do not exist in commercial environments. Organizations that assign Copilot governance entirely to IT teams without involving the Privacy Officer, Records Officer, and General Counsel will produce policies that do not satisfy legal obligations, governance councils without the authority to make binding decisions, and incidents that trace back to decisions that were never made.

5.1 AI Governance Council: Government-Required Membership

The public sector AI Governance Council requires members with statutory or regulatory authority, not just organizational influence. Every role listed below is required for a federal deployment. State, local, and higher education organizations should adapt based on their specific governance structure.

Role	Why Required in Government
Agency CIO or Deputy CIO	Statutory technology authority under the Clinger-Cohen Act; owns the ATO relationship with the Authorizing Official; required chair or co-chair
CISO	Direct line to ISSO and security control assessment; connects the governance council to the ongoing FISMA continuous monitoring program
Senior Agency Official for Privacy (SAOP)	Statutory obligation for PIA and Privacy Act compliance; must be a voting member, not an advisory role

Agency Records Officer	Federal Records Act and NARA obligations; identifies record-qualifying Copilot outputs before deployment begins; cannot be added after launch
General Counsel or Chief Counsel	AUP legal review and approval; FOIA implication determination; labor relations and collective bargaining assessment
Chief Human Capital Officer	Federal employee communications; union and employee association coordination; training policy authority
Program Office Representatives (rotating)	Mission-specific use case advocacy; career staff adoption feedback; operational policy input
AI Program Manager (career position)	Day-to-day governance operations; this role must be held by a career employee, not a political appointee, to survive leadership transitions

5.2 The Federal AUP: What Commercial Templates Miss

A commercial Acceptable Use Policy template applied to a federal environment will miss statutory obligations that create legal exposure if left unaddressed. The federal AUP must explicitly cover:

- **Classification and CUI handling:** explicit prohibitions on entering classified information into Copilot at any level; specific guidance on which CUI categories the authorized environment can process and which it cannot.
- **Privacy Act compliance:** user obligations when Copilot workflows touch Privacy Act-covered records; requirement to consult the Privacy Officer before using Copilot for new categories of PII processing not covered by the current PIA.
- **Records management:** user responsibility for routing record-qualifying Copilot outputs to records-managed systems; the specific records schedule that applies to each output category.
- **FOIA and public records:** confirmation that Copilot interaction logs and AI-generated outputs used in official decisions may be FOIA-responsive; user obligation to preserve this content accordingly.
- **Procurement integrity:** explicit prohibition on using Copilot to draft source selection criteria, evaluation factors, or price estimates without Contracting Officer review. AI-assisted acquisition documents may be subject to GAO bid protest discovery.
- **Incident reporting:** the specific ISSO contact and procedure for reporting suspected data exposure, consistent with the agency's incident response plan and FISMA incident reporting requirements.

5.3 FOIA Governance: Two Questions General Counsel Must Answer

The Freedom of Information Act creates governance questions for public sector Copilot deployments that have no commercial equivalent. General Counsel must address both before the AUP is finalized.

First: are Copilot interaction logs, which include the prompts submitted by employees and the AI responses generated, agency records subject to FOIA? The answer depends on whether logs are retained, how they are used in official business, and how the agency characterizes them in the records schedule. General Counsel must provide a written determination, not an informal opinion.

Second: does a Copilot-generated draft that was used to inform an official decision become a federal record subject to FOIA even if the final document was written by a human? Deliberative process privilege may apply in some contexts, but it requires legal analysis specific to the agency's jurisdiction and the nature of the decision. Both determinations should be reflected in the AUP before the document is approved.

Section 6: Deployment Framework

Armely deploys Copilot in three waves in government environments, with one additional constraint that does not apply to commercial organizations: each wave launch is gated on authorization status, not only on adoption metrics. No wave launches before the ISSO confirms that the authorization documentation covers the planned scope and user population of that wave.

6.1 The Three-Wave Model for Government

Wave	Scope	Authorization Gate
Wave 1: Foundation (Weeks 1 to 8 post-authorization)	25 to 100 pilot users across 3 to 4 program areas; career staff and senior administrators; no classified or CUI-intensive workflows in pilot scope	IATT or full ATO in place before first license is activated; ISSO sign-off on the Wave 1 user population and use case scope
Wave 2: Expansion (Weeks 9 to 20)	20 to 30% of total planned users; all major program offices and administrative functions; operations and compliance functions introduced in this wave	Full ATO for production use; governance council operational and meeting on cadence; AUP signed and distributed to all users
Wave 3: Broad Deployment (Weeks 21 to 36)	Remaining population with new employee onboarding integrated; records management capture mechanisms validated	No additional authorization gate; proceeds when Wave 2 adoption metrics meet thresholds and the governance council has reviewed Wave 2 incident and policy data

6.2 Wave 1 Design in Government

The Wave 1 cohort composition matters as much in government as it does in commercial organizations, but the selection logic is different. In government, the most valuable Wave 1 participants are career staff with strong peer credibility across the program office, not the most technically enthusiastic employees. Political appointees are generally not appropriate Wave 1 participants, both because their tenure may not extend through the full deployment and because their visible adoption or skepticism carries different organizational weight than career staff advocacy.

The Wave 2 progression gates in government are calibrated slightly lower than commercial thresholds to account for government culture factors: greater than 55 percent daily active usage at Week 6, NPS above 35 among career staff at Week 4, at least three documented use cases with mission-relevant impact evidence, and no unresolved P1 or P2 technical incidents. The governance council must have met at least twice with all statutory roles present before Wave 2 launches.

Section 7: Training That Works in Government

Generic training fails in government for the same reason it fails in commercial environments, but the specific failure modes are different. Government employees are not resistant to new tools. They are resistant to tools that were not designed for their work context, that ignore the oversight environment they operate in, and that treat their domain expertise as something to be replaced rather than amplified. Training that addresses these concerns directly produces adoption. Training that ignores them produces polite attendance and quiet disuse.

7.1 Five Principles for Government Training

- **Lead with mission, not productivity metrics:** government employees measure their work against mission outcomes, not hourly output rates. Open every session by connecting Copilot to

specific mission capacity the leadership has identified. Do not open with vendor-provided ROI statistics.

- **Acknowledge the scrutiny environment directly:** career staff work under FOIA, Inspector General review, congressional oversight, and audit. The training must address this. Users need to understand what Copilot can and cannot surface, what the verification obligation is, and how the AUP protects them as well as the agency.
- **Respect domain expertise:** career professionals at GS-13 and above have significant substantive expertise. Frame Copilot as a tool that amplifies that expertise rather than one that replaces it. Any framing that suggests AI can perform the analytical work of experienced career staff will generate resistance that is difficult to reverse.
- **Build classification awareness into every session:** every government training track includes explicit guidance on what may not be entered into Copilot prompts. This is not a separate compliance module. It is a thread that runs through the entire session.
- **Use government-appropriate practice content:** hands-on exercises must use Armely's government sample document library (policy memos, budget justifications, congressional correspondence templates, program status reports). Never instruct participants to use real agency data or real case materials in training exercises.

7.2 Training by Role

Track	Target Audience	Government-Specific Notes
SES and Senior Leader	SES, senior career leaders	Mission outcome framing throughout; FOIA and records obligations for leadership content; governance council role explained; maximum 8 participants; in-person strongly preferred
Career Staff Knowledge Worker	GS-7 through GS-15 analysts, specialists, program officers	Government sample documents for all hands-on exercises; CUI awareness module; records management obligations for Copilot outputs; AUP deep-dive; 4 hours across 2 sessions
Procurement and Contracting	Contracting officers, specialists, program contracting staff	FAR/DFARS restrictions on AI-assisted acquisition documents; prohibition on AI-drafted source selection without CO review; GAO bid protest implications of AI-generated acquisition content
Manager Track	Supervisors and managers at all GS levels	Federal labor relations: handling union inquiries, reporting concerns to labor relations, EEO considerations for AI-assisted performance documentation
Compliance Supplement	All Copilot users without exception	Mandatory 1 hour before license activation: AUP requirements; CUI and classification handling; records management; FOIA awareness; incident reporting procedure

7.3 Section 508 Is Not Optional

Section 508 of the Rehabilitation Act requires that federal agencies' electronic and information technology be accessible to people with disabilities. This obligation applies to every training material delivered in a federal Copilot deployment. Slide decks, participant workbooks, job aids, quick reference cards, and any video content must meet WCAG 2.1 AA standards before the first session is delivered. Delivering non-compliant training materials to a federal agency creates legal exposure for both the agency and any implementation partner involved. This review must happen before delivery, not after.

7.4 The Government Champion Network

Champions in government should be recruited voluntarily, not assigned. In unionized environments, the champion role must be described accurately to employees and their representatives so it is not perceived as a management surveillance function. Champions operate through the agency's existing internal channels. Recognition runs through the agency's established employee recognition programs, not through external vendor-managed programs. The champion Teams channel lives inside the agency tenant. The monthly community call is owned by the AI Program Manager, not the implementation partner, within the first three months. Programs that keep champion management external to the agency fail to sustain adoption after the implementation engagement closes.

Section 8: Risk Management

Public sector Copilot deployments carry a risk profile that differs materially from commercial deployments. The following risks are the most consistently observed across Armely's government engagements. They are not hypothetical. Each one has caused real program delays, budget consumption, and in some cases program termination in agencies that did not address them before deployment began.

8.1 Authorization and Compliance Risks

- **ATO process delays the launch by 60 or more days:** mitigate by making the authorization workstream the first item on the project plan, not a parallel track. Engage the ISSO in Week 1 of planning. Build the timeline around the conservative ATO scenario. Pursue an IATT for pilot testing activities while the full authorization is in progress.
- **GCC High feature limitations reduce capability below what leadership was shown:** mitigate by completing a feature parity review using current Microsoft GCC High documentation before any scope commitment is made. Clarify the demonstration environment when demos are conducted in commercial rather than the agency's actual government cloud.
- **Classification incident: career staff enters CUI or classified content into Copilot:** mitigate through explicit AUP prohibition reinforced in every training session; mandatory classification awareness training before license activation; Purview audit logging capturing interaction metadata from day one for investigation if needed.
- **Federal employee union raises an objection after deployment has begun:** mitigate by completing the union notification assessment with HR and General Counsel before the Wave 1 announcement. If consultation is required under the collective bargaining agreement, it must happen before the program is communicated to employees, not as a response to an objection.

8.2 Oversight and Political Risks

- **Political transition affects executive sponsorship mid-deployment:** mitigate by establishing career SES or program office co-sponsorship alongside any political appointee sponsor. Document the program in mission terms, not in terms of a specific administration's priorities. The career co-sponsor carries the program through leadership transitions.
- **OMB or GAO oversight inquiry into the agency's AI deployment:** mitigate by maintaining governance documentation, the AUP, the PIA, and the ATO documentation in oversight-ready form from day one. The governance council charter and meeting records are the audit trail. Agencies that cannot produce these documents on short notice will spend program time and budget on inquiry response instead of deployment.
- **FOIA request targets Copilot interaction logs or AI-generated draft documents:** mitigate by obtaining General Counsel's written FOIA guidance before Wave 1, aligning interaction log retention with that guidance, and briefing the records officer on preservation obligations before deployment.

8.3 Higher Education-Specific Risks

- **FERPA violation:** Copilot use in a student-facing workflow that includes educational records without FERPA-compliant authorization creates institutional liability. Every higher education use case must be reviewed against FERPA before inclusion in the approved use case list.
- **Faculty governance resistance:** faculty senates and academic governance bodies may assert authority over technology affecting instruction or research. Engage the Provost's office and relevant faculty governance structures before communicating the deployment broadly.
- **Research data compliance:** Copilot use in federally funded research workflows without data management plan review creates grant compliance risk. The research compliance office must be represented on the governance council.

Section 9: ROI and Mission Impact Measurement

Mission impact measurement in government requires a different framing from commercial ROI. Agency CXOs reporting to OMB, congressional appropriators, or departmental leadership need measurement language that connects Copilot investment to mission outcomes. Presenting productivity economics to a congressional oversight committee produces the wrong conversation. Presenting mission capacity freed for higher-value work produces the right one.

9.1 Establish Baselines Before Wave 1

Capture baseline measurements before any Copilot license is activated. A brief pre-deployment survey across the Wave 1 cohort is sufficient. Measure time spent per week on drafting correspondence, briefings, and reports by role category; time per week in meetings and on post-meeting documentation; time to locate precedent documents or historical program information through current search tools; and a subjective mission-effectiveness rating on a ten-point scale. Five minutes of baseline work before go-live is the difference between a quarterly mission impact report that drives continued investment and a quarterly report that produces questions about whether the investment was justified.

9.2 What the Quarterly Dashboard Must Show

The AI Program Manager produces a quarterly mission impact dashboard for the agency CIO and governance council. The dashboard uses mission language throughout. It includes staff capacity recaptured per quarter expressed as full-time equivalent hours redirected to mission-critical work; adoption stage distribution across the licensed population; use case count with mission outcome description for each verified use case; compliance health (AUP incidents, records management exceptions, authorization-related events); governance council activity including decisions made and policies updated; and NPS trend among career staff. If daily active usage is below 55 percent at the end of Wave 2, the conversation is about adoption intervention, not about the technology.

Implementation Checklists: Available on Request

Armely maintains three-stage government implementation checklists covering Compliance and Authorization Readiness,

Technical and Governance Readiness, and Wave 2 Progression Gate.

These are available as standalone working documents for organizations using Armely as their implementation partner.

Contact advisory@armely.com to request the full government checklist package.

About Armely

Armely is a Microsoft-focused technology advisory firm that helps public sector organizations make responsible, measurable investments in Microsoft 365 and AI capabilities. Our public sector practice brings together government-specific compliance expertise, technical deployment experience in GCC and GCC High environments, and a training and change management approach built for government culture.

We work with federal civilian agencies, defense-adjacent organizations, state and local governments, and public universities. Every engagement reflects the understanding that public sector technology investments carry accountability obligations that commercial deployments do not. We work with organizations that are ready to invest in doing this correctly rather than quickly.

Engage Armely

To discuss your commercial Copilot deployment, contact Armely at advisory@armely.com or visit www.armely.com to schedule an executive briefing.

Our team is available for readiness assessments, full-program implementation, and advisory engagements scoped to where your organization is in the process.

ARMELY TECHNOLOGY ADVISORY

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This document is intended for CXO and executive audiences at federal, state, local, and higher education organizations.